

Arroz con Pollo



T*his is the chicken and rice that my wife loved so much. The chorizo is cooked with chicken thighs and finished with seasoning and rice and a great deal of chopped cilantro stems that I keep in my freezer. A great, satisfying dinner.*

Preheat the oven to 400°F.

Spread the pieces of chicken skin outer surface up on a rimmed baking sheet. Sprinkle with $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon of the salt and bake for about 20 minutes. The skin will become nicely browned and dry. (Do not move the pieces of skin while they cook; they should stick to the bottom of the pan as they cook to assure that they remain completely flat and do not shrivel.)

Heat the oil in a skillet over medium heat. When it is hot, add the chicken thighs and chorizo. Brown each side of the thighs for about 8 minutes. Add the onion, garlic, and Italian seasoning and cook for 5 minutes. Add the tomato, cilantro stems, sriracha, and remaining 1 teaspoon salt and cook for another 3 minutes. Stir in the rice, water, and capers. Bring to a boil, then lower the heat, cover, and cook for 30 minutes. Serve with a sprinkling of the chicken skin pieces on top.

Serves 4

4 bone-in chicken thighs
(about 6 ounces each), skin
removed and set aside

$\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoons fine sea salt,
divided

$\frac{1}{2}$ tablespoons extra virgin
olive oil

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup $\frac{1}{2}$ -inch-diced chorizo
(about 4 ounces)

1 cup coarsely chopped
onion

1 tablespoon chopped garlic

1 teaspoon Italian seasoning

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup canned diced tomato

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup chopped cilantro
stems (frozen is fine)

2 teaspoons sriracha or other
chili garlic sauce

1 cup Carolina rice

2 cups water

3 tablespoons capers